

ENGLISH LANGUAGE SS1 – THIRD TERM FULL LESSON NOTES

Teacher: Mrs. Naadzenga Mgbede Grace

WEEK 1

Speech: Intonation Patterns

Intonation refers to the variation in the pitch level of the voice when speaking. It plays a crucial role in conveying meaning beyond the literal interpretation of words. In English, intonation helps to distinguish between statements, questions, commands, and emotions such as surprise, anger, or excitement.

There are two major types of intonation patterns. The falling intonation is used when the voice drops at the end of a sentence, typically in statements, commands, and WH-questions. For example, in the sentence “She is coming,” the voice falls at the end to indicate completion. Rising intonation, on the other hand, occurs when the pitch rises at the end of an utterance, commonly used in yes/no questions such as “Are you coming?”

Learners must understand that incorrect intonation can distort meaning. For instance, using rising intonation in a statement may unintentionally turn it into a question.

Structure: Types of Sentences

Sentences are classified based on their function. A declarative sentence makes a statement and ends with a full stop. An interrogative sentence asks a question and ends with a question mark. An imperative sentence gives a command or request, while an exclamatory sentence expresses strong emotion.

Understanding sentence types helps students construct meaningful and grammatically correct expressions in both spoken and written communication.

Writing: Speech Writing

Speech writing involves preparing a structured presentation intended for oral delivery. A good speech begins with an introduction that captures attention, followed by a body that develops ideas logically, and ends with a conclusion that reinforces the message.

Effective speech writing must consider audience, purpose, tone, and clarity. The use of rhetorical devices such as repetition, rhetorical questions, and vivid examples enhances engagement.

WEEK 2

Speech: Oral Composition

Oral composition involves expressing ideas verbally in a clear and organized manner. It requires proper pronunciation, logical sequencing of ideas, and appropriate use of language.

Students are trained to speak fluently on given topics, maintaining coherence and clarity while avoiding unnecessary pauses and repetition.

Vocabulary: Words Associated with Advertising

Advertising vocabulary includes terms such as “promotion,” “brand,” “consumer,” “slogan,” and “marketing.” These words are used in contexts related to selling products or services.

Understanding such vocabulary enhances comprehension of media messages and improves communication in commercial contexts.

Comprehension and Summary: Summarising a Passage

Summarising involves reducing a passage to its essential points without altering the original meaning. Students must identify key ideas, eliminate repetition, and express the summary in their own words.

Structure: Types of Sentences (Continued)

Further emphasis is placed on recognizing sentence types in complex texts and using them appropriately in writing and speech.

WEEK 3

Speech: Intonation Patterns (Continued)

Students engage in practical exercises to master intonation through dialogue reading and role play. Emphasis is placed on how intonation conveys attitudes and emotions.

Structure: Complex Sentences

A complex sentence contains one independent clause and at least one subordinate clause. The subordinate clause cannot stand alone as a complete sentence.

Examples include sentences introduced by conjunctions such as “because,” “although,” and “when.” Mastery of complex sentences improves writing sophistication.

Writing: Descriptive Essay (Oral Composition)

A descriptive essay focuses on vividly portraying a person, place, object, or event. It relies heavily on sensory details, including sight, sound, smell, taste, and touch.

Students are encouraged to organize their descriptions logically and use figurative language to create imagery.

WEEK 4

Speech: Emphatic Stress

Emphatic stress involves placing extra force on certain words to highlight importance or contrast. For example, in the sentence “I said *now*, not later,” the stressed word changes the meaning.

Students learn how stress affects meaning and improves clarity in communication.

Vocabulary: Synonyms

Synonyms are words that have similar meanings. For example, “happy” and “joyful.” Learning synonyms enriches vocabulary and prevents repetition in writing.

Structure: Clauses (Independent and Dependent)

An independent clause expresses a complete thought, while a dependent clause relies on another clause for meaning. Understanding clauses helps in constructing complex sentences.

Writing: Article Writing

Article writing involves presenting information or opinions on a topic in a structured format. It requires a clear introduction, detailed body, and logical conclusion.

WEEK 5

Speech: Polite Requests and Greetings

Politeness in speech involves using expressions such as “please,” “thank you,” and “excuse me.” Greetings vary depending on context and time of day.

Students are taught appropriate social expressions to enhance communication etiquette.

Vocabulary: Antonyms

Antonyms are words with opposite meanings, such as “hot” and “cold.” Learning antonyms improves understanding of word relationships.

Comprehension: Contextual Meaning

Students learn to derive the meaning of unfamiliar words from context rather than relying solely on dictionaries.

Structure: Noun Clauses

A noun clause functions as a noun within a sentence. It can serve as subject, object, or complement.

WEEK 6

Speech: Expository Oral Composition

Expository speaking involves explaining or informing. It requires clarity, factual accuracy, and logical organization.

Vocabulary: Investment Terms

Words such as “capital,” “interest,” “dividend,” and “profit” are introduced to familiarize students with financial language.

Comprehension: Note-Making

Students learn to extract key information and present it in concise note form using headings and subheadings.

Structure: Adjectival Clauses

Adjectival clauses describe nouns and are introduced by relative pronouns such as “who,” “which,” and “that.”

WEEK 7

Speech: Persuasive Speaking

Persuasive speaking aims to convince the audience. It involves presenting arguments, evidence, and appealing to emotions or logic.

Structure: Adjectival Clauses (Continued)

Further exercises focus on identifying and constructing adjectival clauses correctly.

WEEK 8

Comprehension: Reading Speed and Accuracy

Students practice reading quickly while maintaining understanding. This skill is essential for examinations.

Vocabulary: Political Register

Words related to politics such as “democracy,” “election,” and “governance” are introduced.

Writing: Argumentative Essay

An argumentative essay presents a claim supported by evidence. It includes introduction, arguments, counterarguments, and conclusion.

WEEK 9

Speech: Oral Description

Students describe events or objects verbally, focusing on clarity and vividness.

Structure: Commonly Misspelt Words

Attention is given to frequently misspelt words to improve writing accuracy.

Vocabulary: Photography Terms

Words such as “lens,” “focus,” and “exposure” are taught.

WEEK 10

Speech: Identifying Speaker’s Style

Students learn to recognize tone, mood, and style in spoken language.

Structure: Active and Passive Voice

In active voice, the subject performs the action, while in passive voice, the subject receives the action.

Vocabulary: British and American Spelling

Differences such as “colour” and “color” are examined.

WEEK 11

Speech: Listening for Main Ideas

Students practice identifying key points in spoken passages, improving listening comprehension.

WEEK 12

Speech: Revision of Consonant Sounds

Students revise consonant sounds, focusing on correct pronunciation and articulation.

Structure: Synonyms

Further reinforcement of synonyms is provided.

Writing: Formal and Informal Letters

Students learn the differences in tone, format, and language between formal and informal letters. Formal letters are structured and polite, while informal letters are conversational.
